Adam YEO
Curriculum Vitae

CONTACT INFORMATION

BP V 81 Bondoukou, Côte d'Ivoire

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Education

2022-2024 **Researcher in Typography on African Writing Systems.**
Atelier National de Recherche Typographique (ANRT), Nancy (France)
Project: *Creating a Typeface for the Bete Script*
Supervisor: Thomas Huot-Marchand
https://anrt-nancy.fr/fr

2016-2021 **Ph.D. in Graphic Design**
Theory and Practice of Graphic Design
School of Design, Nanjing University of the Arts, China

Thesis: *The Representation of Graphic Symbols in the Languages and Writing Systems of Côte d'Ivoire*
Supervisor: Dr. Fang Cao
https://en.nua.edu.cn/2010/1128/c5490a39963/page.htm

2013-2016 **Master of Arts:** Artistic Design - Illustration,
School of Fine Arts, Central China Normal University (CCNU), China

Thesis: *Children's Book Illustrations in Côte d'Ivoire: Research and Practice.*
Supervisor: Dr. Guiyi Hui
https://english.ccnu.edu.cn/index.htm

2012-2013 **Chinese Language Studies**
HSK4 Level

2004-2008 **Bachelor of Arts: Painting**
School of Fine Arts, Abidjan ,Côte d'Ivoire

Thesis: *The phenomenon of street vendors as source of artistic creation*
Supervisor : Prof. Touré Kinigouani (ENS)

Professional Affiliations & Experience

09/2024 -Present **Assistant Professor**

UFR : Sciences des Arts, Industries Culturelles et Communication,
Teaching Arts, Design and Multimedia (Infographic)
University of Bondoukou

2023-11- Present **Contracted Type Designer - Google Fonts**
Expanding Latin typeface options for African languages.
Designed the "Matemasie" typeface, inspired by the Adinkra symbol "Mate Masie," symbolizing communication, wisdom, and connection
https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Matemasie/about

2023-09 **Teaching Graphic Design & Typography Workshops**
Lycée Cpes Chopin, Nancy, France.

2021-07.2022-9 **Graphic Designer & Design Researcher**
Nanjing YA Cultural Creative Co Ltd- Nanjing, China
Created marketing visuals, logos, icons, brand guidelines, and packaging designs

2018-03.2021-07 **Graphic Designer**
Hoooly Design - Shanghai, China
Developed product packaging, illustrations, and corporate branding.

2021-05. 2021-06 **Teaching Internship**
As a doctoral student, I participated in a teaching internship at the Nanjing University of the Arts, China.

2019-07.2020-06 **Art Teacher**
Ke Luo Art Fu Training Center, Nanjing ,China.
Taught fundamental art concepts, including color theory and basic drawing.

2016-2017 **Graphic Designer / Illustrator**,
Reverso advertising Agency, Côte d'Ivoire ,Abidjan.
Developing concepts and artwork, creating graphic design solutions from concept through completion, (both digital and printing design).

2014 **Illustrateur / Artiste conceptuel,**
Wuhan TIANSHANG TECHNOLOGY
Concept design sketching, creating character design & illustrations, Digital painting.

2008-2009 **Member of laboratory,** *"* ACTUAL ART" Creative Research laboratory on Contemporary Art, managed by Oka Valery.

Research Interests

- Theoretical and Practical Research in Graphic Design
- Development and Design of African Typefaces
- African Languages, Writing Systems, and Graphic Symbols
- Art and Design in Africa

- African Design History
- Visual Communication Principles
- African Cultural Studies, Art, and Design
- Études culturelles africaines, Art et design
- Cultural Industries in Africa
- Design Culture and Innovation

Publications

Yeo, A. Debbie, A. MacLean, J. Patel, N. (2023) **To Unicode Technical Commitee**
Document de travail sur le Bété (alphabet ivoirien) , Nov. 2023.
L2023

Yeo, A. and Cao, F. (2021) **"A Creative Research Process for a Modern African Graphic Design Identity; The Case of Ivory Coast."**
Art and Design Review, **9**, 210-231. doi: 10.4236/adr.2021.92017.

Yeo, A. and Cao, F. (2021) **"Study on the Application of the Bété Script in Modern Graphic Design."**
Art and Design Review, **9**, 156-179. doi: 10.4236/adr.2021.92

Grants, Fellowships & Prizes,

2026-03/2026-11 **VIEWS Visiting Fellow (Lent Term 2026)**

I'm leading a IEWS Visiting Fellow (Lent Term 2026) – Faculty of Classics, University of Cambridge
Research affiliate of the Visual Interactions in Early Writing Systems (VIEWS) project. Research project: *"Writing as Image: A Comparative Visual Study of Bété and Chinese Scripts."*
https://viewsproject.wordpress.com/visiting-fellows/

2021 Third Prize for Excellence in Doctoral Thesis, Nanjing University of the Arts, China

2019 Invited to the World Bank Group Youth Conference, Washington, D.C

2018 "Little Hakka" International Picture Book Competition Award, China

2013 Outstanding Student Award, Central China Normal University (CCNU),

2012 Chinese Government Scholarship for Best Undergraduate Student.

Certifications

Certificat Google UX: UX Design Foundations:

- Empathy, Ideation, Prototyping,

Exhibitions

2025-01
2025-02 ***Betescript :*** *Heritage & Future in the Digital Age*,
An exhibition that aimed to promote this writing by reconciling tradition and innovation, highlighting the importance of preserving this Ivorian cultural heritage by harnessing modern technologies to make it accessible to a wider audience.
French Institute of Côte d'Ivoire, Abidjan

2021-09 ***The Way of Characters***
An Experimental Exhibition on the Modern Way of Chinese Character
Art Design Nanjing University of the Arts Art Museum, Nanjing, China

2019 **Beijing Expo (Painting Works), China**.

2015 ***Africa Day*** Exhibition, Clermont-Ferrand, France.

2014 Group exhibition, "美术之星"THE ART OF STAR WORKS
At the Zhong Nan Museum, Wuhan, China.

2008 Group exhibition at the Palais de la Culture in Abidjan to raise financial aid for orphans, Ivory Coast.

2007 Group exhibition of fine arts students at INSAAC and the Eureka Gallery

2007-07 Workshop at the Plateau District Hotel, followed by another exhibition at the Ivoire Hotel, Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire

Conferences and Talks

2026-03-06 **Seminar:** *"Writing as Image: A Comparative Visual Study of Bété and Chinese Scripts"*
University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK

2025-02-28 **International academic conference on Rethinking Art Criticism: Perspectives on Contemporary Creation in Africa:** *"*
"Art Criticism as a Space for the Symbolic Preservation of African Scripts: The Case of the Bété Script."

University of Bondoukou, Côte d'Ivoire.

2025-01-23 **World Endangered Writing Day***: "Typography, Digital Inclusion, and the Preservation of Minority Scripts: The Bété Case Study"*
Online conference

2025-01 **Keynote Speaker, *FACE - INTERFACE***
Conference on Global Typographic Design and Human-Computer Interaction, *"The Future of Bété Script: Embracing Digital Inclusion"*

Stanford University, California, USA

2025-02 ***Bete Writing: Heritage & Future in the Digital Age*****,**
French Institute of Côte d'Ivoire, Abidjan

2024-06 **Département de DeScripto-LARSH de l'université polytechnique Hautsde-France**

"Understanding the Symbolism of African Masks: The Case of Côte d'Ivoire for a Reappropriation of Motifs and Forms in Contemporary Art"

2023-07 **Inscript Collective Talk**
Integrating cultural diversity through the design of Bete script characters.

2023-06 **Hello Departures Talk Series :**
Imagine a liberated graphic design practice and education outside of systems; transforming from oppression. What do we need to unlearn,explore, do, and reprogram to rethink the graphisme ?
Case Study: Bete Typography
Online Conference

2023-02 ***Primitive and Modern Writings of West Africa: The Case of Bete Writing***
Association Castel coucou, Nancy France

2023-03 **Typographic Renewal of Historical Writing**
OCAD University (Canada) + ANRT, Nancy, France
The Development of the ***Bete*** *Script Font*
Online Conference

2021-05 **International Student Forum**
Nanjing University of the Arts, China
Graphic Symbols and Embodiments of Cultural Concepts in Côte d'Ivoire

2022-09
2022-10 **Forum on the modern approach to the art of Chinese characters**
Renewal of Writing and Migration of Technologies, Nanjing University of the Arts, China

2021-12 **ATypI All Over 2021**
Bete script (Côte d'Ivoire) in typography

Languages

- Fluent in French (spoken and written)
- Professional proficiency in English (spoken and written)
- Intermediate proficiency in Chinese (spoken and written)